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UAE Presidential Court

PRESIDENT, VICE-PRESIDENT DISCUSS NATION'S PROGRESS

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan and His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, met at Al Marmoom in Dubai on Saturday. During the meeting, the leaders engaged in cordial discussions and reviewed a number of issues related to national and citizens' affairs, as well as efforts to support the UAE's development journey and fulfil the aspirations of its people towards a more prosperous future.

GARGASH SLAMS 'DESPERATE' MEDIA CAMPAIGNS AGAINST UAE

'Nation's record of achievement speaks louder'

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, has criticised media campaigns directed against the UAE, describing them as "desperate" and saying the country's record of achievement was a stronger response than engaging with attacks against it.

In a post on X on Saturday, Gargash said the campaigns were based on distortion and rumours set against determination and achievement. He argued that action ultimately carried more weight than reaction, and that confronting what he described as a successful national model was difficult for those behind such campaigns.

Waste of resources

Gargash added that the effort and money spent targeting the UAE represented a waste of resources that could instead have been directed towards "building and development".

His comments follow remarks earlier this week in which he stressed the importance of credibility and balance in media coverage during

Gargash said the effort and money spent targeting the UAE could instead have been directed towards 'building and development'.

a period of heightened regional tensions.

Gargash said accurate reporting was particularly important when competing narratives and misinformation were shaping public understanding of regional events.

He also stressed the importance of realism in diplomacy, saying successful negotiations depended on an accurate assessment of the leverage available to those at the table, rather than exaggeration or escalation.

"Diplomacy and the art of negotiation are a delicate balance between flexibility and steadfastness on a clear position that reflects the national interest," he said. "The success of managing this balance depends on a realistic assessment of the cards available to the negotiator, away from exaggeration and escalation."

Gargash said diplomatic ef-

forts could falter when negotiators misread the balance of power or failed to adopt a realistic approach to the circumstances they faced. "Without an accurate understanding of the balance of power, realism in assessment and balance in performance, efforts falter," he said.

He concluded with a proverb underscoring the need to avoid extremes in negotiations: "As the saying goes: do not be so rigid that you break, nor so soft that you are squeezed."

Diplomacy central

His remarks come as diplomacy remains central to efforts to consolidate stability in the region following months of Iran conflict.

Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian said the peace memorandum of understanding between Iran and the United States was in the interests of Iran, the region and the wider world.

Pezeshkian said implementation of the agreement would prevent further "chaos, aggression and insecurity" and allow regional states to pursue stability and development, according to a statement published by his office.

SEE ALSO P5, 6

Record number of students return to schools

11 new schools and educational complexes opened

DUBAI

BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN
Chief Reporter

Over 1.277 million students across the UAE head back to classrooms today, even as relevant authorities continue to monitor the regional situation, with schools keeping in place the contingency plans they developed last year should

circumstances change again. According to the Ministry of Education, more than 1,180 public and private schools across the UAE are ready to welcome over 1.277 million students for the 2026-27 academic year, including 26,700 new students joining the public system for the first time.

Ahead of the new term, the Ministry has opened 11 new schools and educational complexes, deployed 5,810 school buses and distributed around 8 million textbooks.

Meanwhile, in Abu Dhabi

specifically, authorities have readied 10,000 school buses to serve more than 279,000 pupils across the emirate. Federal government employees in the UAE will be allowed to adjust their working hours as children return to school, under a back-to-school policy designed to give parents more flexibility at the start of the new academic year.

Elsewhere, Dubai Police have organised a series of traffic safety training sessions for more than 140 security guards working across 35 schools in Dubai.

SEE ALSO P2

Advanced sciences and tech programme launched

Initiative links education, research, talent development with industry needs

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan has issued a decision establishing the National Programme for Advanced Sciences and Technologies, an integrated national initiative designed to link education, research and development, and talent-building with the needs of the country's strategic and advanced industries.

The programme will work to develop an integrated national education and research system that connects education and scientific research with the requirements of strategic sectors and advanced technologies.

It will also support investment in promising national talent and help qualify Emiratis in science, advanced technologies and priority future specialisations.

The programme aims to strengthen industrial capabilities, increase the competitiveness of Emirati products and support national sovereignty in vital sectors. Its key tracks

cover technical education, national talent development, talent attraction, and technical research and innovation in advanced scientific fields.

Higher Committee

A Higher Committee will oversee the programme and its tracks, chaired by Sheikh Mansour Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Vice-President, Deputy Prime Minister and Chairman of the Presidential Court. Sheikh Abdullah Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Foreign Affairs, will serve as Deputy Chairman.

The Higher Committee will also include Mohammed Bin Abdullah Al Gergawi, Minister of Cabinet Affairs; Dr Sultan Bin Ahmed Al Jaber, Minister of Industry and Advanced Technology; Dr Abdulrahman Bin Abdulmannan Al Awar, Minister of Human Resources and Emiratisation and Acting Minister of Higher Education and Scientific Research; Mohammed Bin Mubarak Bin Fadel Al Mazrouei, Minister of State for Defence Affairs; Dr Ahmed Mubarak Bin Nawli Al Mazrouei, Head of the Office of the UAE President for Strategic Affairs; and Faisal Abdulaziz Al Bannai, Adviser to the UAE President for Strategic Research and Advanced Technology Affairs.

NATION

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BUSINESS

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